

Put the Team Before Yourself: Wrap-Up, Featuring Keith Gray

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When a team member fully understands and embraces the concept of *We versus Me*, great things happen. Pat Summitt often used the words “Selfless versus Selfish” to describe the desired attitude of her players. To Coach Summitt, the team was and always needed to be the center of the program. In business, the corporate team must also remain the core, the center and the essence of the enterprise.

In this module, we learned that role players are essential to greatness. Effective team play will always be greater than one superstar. A well-organized team places equal value on heroes and pacesetters in order to achieve success.

Second, we saw that investing in people and being honest about expectations clarifies roles and encourages the practice of putting team ambitions above individual interest. Relationships nurture commitment and commitment allow space for sacrifice when working toward a common goal.

Finally, teamwork is taught and modeled by leaders. Strong relationships and a commitment to honesty are the foundational elements of influence. It's influence that gives the leader the authority to blaze new trails while leading from the front.

Your team members will be more likely to take risks for the collective good if they trust you. Trust is the product of authentic authority. Most great teams and organizations have a standout talent. But even superstars need a supporting cast. A healthy team structure recognizes each member as vital to achieving common goals.

When the team wins, everyone wins. In the words of Pat Summitt ...

Coach Pat Summitt

“Teamwork is not created by like mindedness. As in a family, you have to be generous enough to take pleasure in someone else's success, not just your own. And you have to have the smarts to realize that no one succeeds alone. As Alex Haley once said, ‘If you see a turtle sitting on a fence post, you know, he didn't get there by himself.’”